



**Bureau of Experts at the Council of Ministers
Official Translation Department**

The Veterinary Quarantine Law of the GCC States

Royal Decree No. M/26
July 30, 2003

Translation of Saudi Laws

NOTES:

1. This translation is provided for guidance. The governing text is the Arabic text.
2. The translation of Saudi laws takes the following into consideration:
 - Words used in the singular form include the plural and vice versa.
 - Words used in the masculine form include the feminine.
 - Words used in the present tense include the present as well as the future.
 - The word “person” or “persons” and their related pronouns (he, his, him, they, their, them, and who) refer to a natural and legal person.

For any comments or inquiries, please contact the Official Translation Department at:

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The Veterinary Quarantine Law of the GCC States

Article 1: Definitions and Terms:

Minister: Minister of agriculture or the competent minister.

Ministry: Ministry of agriculture or any agency under whose authority the veterinary quarantines fall.

Animal: All animals, including fish and birds, whether for consumption, breeding, use, ornament, or otherwise.

Slaughter Animals: Animals imported for slaughter and consumption, or those kept under veterinary supervision from their arrival until they are slaughtered.

Breeding Animals: Animals imported for purposes other than slaughter, such as fattening, reproduction, milk production, crossbreeding, and other purposes.

Equine Family: Horses, mules, donkeys, zebras, and ponies.

Ornamental Animals: Animals kept in homes, such as cats, dogs, parrots, peacocks, and domestic ornamental fish.

Animal Products: Fresh, dried, chilled, frozen, smoked, and processed red and white meat; meat powder; fish powder; fresh, powdered, and concentrated dairy and dairy products and derivatives; eggs for consumption, hatching, and scientific purposes; semen; embryos; and animal gelatin.

Animal by-products: It includes manure, fresh and dried blood, horns, hooves, hair, wool, skin, fur, feathers, animal manure, bones, intestines, stomach, rumens, animal refuse, fish fins and bones, bone powder, and shells.

Animal Feed: Processed or unprocessed food materials that contain meat, poultry, and fish as well as their products, derivatives, and by-products, and are used to feed animals.

Animal Biological Products: Vaccines; serums; and live, attenuated, or killed viruses and microorganisms for use in the diagnosis, research, treatment, and prevention of animal diseases.

Animal Tools: Saddles, harnesses, farrier tools, covers, blankets, and all other tools used with the animal.

Supervising Veterinarian: The veterinarian appointed by the competent government agency in charge of veterinary quarantines.

Competent Veterinary Authority: The veterinary department responsible for veterinary quarantine.

Quarantine: Any designated site or facility where animals are isolated for veterinary monitoring to verify that such animals are free from epidemic diseases, without allowing the animals to directly or indirectly mix with other animals upon arrival to the country or to the place designated for the quarantine of animals and their products.

Epidemic Disease: Any infectious and contagious diseases classified in List (A) and List (B) according to the classification of the World Organization for Animal Health, including any amendments thereto.

Animal Consignment and Transit: Animals of all types, as well as their products, derivatives, or by-products that are imported into, exported from, or transit through the country.



Approved Certificate (Attested): A certificate issued by a government agency. If such certificate is issued in a non-GCC country, it shall be attested by the embassy of the country or any of the embassies of the member states or their representatives, or their designees.

State: Any GCC state.

Member States: GCC states.

Article 2

The import and export of all types of animals, their products, derivatives, by-products, animal feed made of animal components, animal biological products, and tools into and from any of the member states shall be subject to this Law. The competent minister shall regulate the import and export of the same and specify the ports of entry and exit for animals, as designated in the state where veterinary quarantine facilities exist. The minister may designate additional entry points as dictated by public interest.

Article 3

Any person seeking to import or export animals, animal products, animal by-products, or biological products into and from any of the member states shall submit an application to the competent ministry to obtain the necessary license from the competent veterinary authority.

Article 4

- A. Animal consignments as well as their products, derivatives, and by-products, and biological products shall be held in veterinary quarantines for monitoring and necessary testing before entry thereof.
- B. Animal consignments, animal feed, animal biological products, and tools shall not enter any of the member states from a non-member state except through approved points of entry where veterinary quarantines are available. The competent veterinary authority may authorize, when necessary, the entry of imported animals from some or all of such entry points, and the placement of such animals in veterinary quarantines for a period specified thereby. Animals herded into the country for the purpose of slaughter, grazing, or breeding shall not enter until they are examined by the supervising veterinarian and a determination is made regarding such animals.



Article 5

Animal consignments and animal feed arriving from any non-member state or from a region outside the member states for consumption, manufacturing, or other purposes must be accompanied by the following documents:

- a) A valid official veterinary health certificate from the exporting country, indicating distinctive marks, origin, confirmation of examination immediately prior to consignment, and confirmation that they are free from the infectious and epidemic diseases specified by the competent veterinary authority. The certificate must be approved, signed, and sealed with an official stamp.
- b) A report from the captain of the ship or airplane, or the person in charge of the means of transport regarding any mortality or the outbreak of any disease among the imported animals during transport. The report shall also confirm that such animals did not come into contact with any other animals infected with any epidemic or infectious disease, nor did they disembark or pass through infected areas during transport. The documents provided for in paragraphs (A) and (B) of this Article and any other required documents shall be presented to the veterinary quarantine officer upon arrival of the consignment and prior to unloading.
- c) A certificate of origin approved by the embassy of the exporting country, if any, or by the embassy of any of the member states.
- d) An approved certificate stating that the slaughter was carried out according to the Islamic tradition for meat imports from a non-Islamic country; such certificate must specify the slaughter date and the expiration date.
- e) A certificate of clearance from radioactive materials issued by the exporting country where a radioactive leak is suspected to have occurred; such certificate must be valid and approved.

The competent veterinary authority may seize and dispose of, at the importer's expense and under the supervision of the competent authority, any consignment that, upon examination, is established to have undergone a change that may pose a risk to human health.

Article 6

The entry of any animal into the state from any non-member state or from a region outside the member states where there is an epidemic disease shall be prohibited. The same shall apply to the entry of any animal that, during its transit, has been in contact with animals from a country where there is an epidemic disease.

Article 7

The entry of any animal into the state from any non-member state shall be prohibited if it is found, after inspection upon arrival at any of the state's ports, airports, or border points, that such animal is infected with an epidemic disease.

The importer shall be required to return the infected animal or animals to the country from which they were imported at his own expense. In the case of animals that have perished from a contagious disease, they shall be burned and buried according to applicable health procedures.

The concerned state must immediately notify the General Secretariat of the GCC of the rejected consignments in order to notify other member states.



Article 8

Animals suspected of being infected with an epidemic or infectious disease shall be kept in quarantine for not less than the incubation period of the suspected epidemic disease in order to conduct the necessary tests. Such animals shall then be subjected to the health requirements determined by the veterinarian.

Article 9

For slaughter and breeding animals which are accompanied by the documents stipulated in Article 5 of this Law and are not suspected of having an epidemic or infectious disease:

- The owner of such animals may transport them to the slaughterhouse or the breeding location, provided that the supervising veterinarian at the nearest veterinary center to their location is notified upon their arrival in order to monitor such animals for the period he deems necessary.

Article 10

For animals imported from a country where some vaccination regulations do not apply to certain diseases, such animals shall be vaccinated and immunized, then placed in veterinary quarantine for a period of not less than the incubation period of the epidemic or infectious disease.

Article 11

The competent authorities shall have the right to prohibit any means of transport from entering the state if it is found, based on a report from the competent veterinary authority, that it carries or has carried any animals, animal products, or animal extracts infected with an infectious disease, and that the transport vehicle was not properly disinfected in a manner that ensures that such disease is not transmitted to humans or animals.

Article 12

If a transport vehicle arrives in the state and its consignment of animals, animal products, or animal extracts is found, upon inspection, to pose a risk to humans or animals, the competent veterinary authority may order its disinfection in the manner it determines and at the importer's expense. The competent veterinary authority may also order placing the consignment in the veterinary quarantine to take necessary actions in accordance with this Law.

Article 13

The owner or importer of the animals shall transport such animals at his own expense to the veterinary quarantine site designated by the Ministry. He shall provide adequate feed and water for his animals during their stay at the quarantine according to the instructions of the supervising veterinarian; if he fails to do so, the competent veterinary authority may take the necessary action as dictated by interest and the wellbeing of the animals.

Article 14

If there is no quarantine facility in the area, the supervising veterinarian shall, when necessary, isolate the animals in a separate site to prevent contact with other animals. In such case, said site shall serve as a quarantine facility in accordance with the provisions provided for in this Law.



Article 15

The import and export of the equine family to and from member states shall be subject to internationally applicable laws and requirements.

Article 16

The following animal products may be imported into the member states:

- a) Semen used for artificial insemination and embryos.
- b) Poultry eggs for hatching.

If such products are accompanied by a certificate of origin and an approved veterinary certificate attesting that they are produced from animals free from diseases or any genetic defects provided that samples are taken to conduct the necessary tests.

Article 17

If it is found after conducting the necessary tests that any of the products provided for in Article 16 is infected with an epidemic disease, the importer shall be required to re-export or to destroy such product at his own expense under the supervision of the competent authority.

Article 18

The competent veterinary authority may quarantine any animal inside the state if it is infected or is suspected of being infected with an epidemic disease, and shall apply internal quarantine measures. Animal products or extracts shall be disinfected and sterilized if possible; otherwise, they shall be destroyed.

Article 19

In the event of the presence of a disease in an exporting state, the importing member state may apply this Law to the animals exported thereto from the exporting state.

Article 20

Animals, animal products, and animal by-products intended for export outside the member states shall be inspected by the supervising veterinarian authorized to issue government veterinary certificates; this shall be in accordance with the laws of the member states. A health veterinary certificate (Appendix 1) shall be issued to the exporter, confirming that the animals are free from epidemic and infectious diseases. The certificate shall specify the number, type, and distinctive marks of animals, animal products, and animal by-products intended for export, as well as the destination and date of export. The competent veterinary authority may take any actions it deems necessary regarding inspection and health requirements or necessary vaccinations of the animals prior to granting authorization for export.

Article 21

All consignments of animals, animal products, and animal by-products passing through the state in transit shall be subject to inspection by the competent veterinary authority in accordance with the provisions of this Law.



Article 22

Animal feed consignments shall be accompanied by a veterinary health certificate issued by the exporting country, establishing that they are free from all epidemic and infectious diseases, toxins especially fungal toxins, and forbidden substances such as spilled blood and pork.

Article 23

Each state shall have the right to determine the penalties to be imposed against any person who violates the provisions of this Law or any of its implementing regulations.

Article 24

The member states shall prepare the implementing regulations for this Law, provided that the General Secretariat of the GCC is provided with such regulations.

Article 25

The minister in each state shall implement the provisions of this Law.

Article 26

The application of this Law shall be mandatory six months following its approval by the Supreme Council.



Council Emblem

State Emblem

Country Name

Veterinary (Appendix 1)

Ministry

Department

Veterinary Health Certificate

Certificate No.:

1- Place of Issue:

2- Day:

Month:

Year:

3- Name of Exporter:

4- Address of Exporter:

5- Name of Consignee:

6- Address of Consignee:

7- Type and Species of Animal:

8- Number of Animals:

Males:

In Figures ()

In Words ()

Females: In

In Figures ()

In Words ()

9- Means of Transportation:

10- Port of Export:

11- Origin of the Animal:

12- Distinctive Marks:

13- Vaccinations:

14- Remarks:

I, the undersigned, Dr. _____, a veterinarian affiliated with _____ at the Ministry of _____, hereby certify that I have examined the animals specified above, that I observed no signs of disease thereon, and that they were in good health and fit for export.

Name:

Official Seal

Signature:

Date:

Director of:

Note: This certificate shall be valid for a period of one week from the date of issuance, unless otherwise stated.



Council Emblem

State Emblem

Country Name

Veterinary (Appendix 2)

Ministry

Department

Veterinary Vaccination Certificate

Certificate No.:

1- Place of Issue:

2- Day: Month: Year:

3- Name of Owner:

4- Address of Owner:

5- Type and Species of Animal:

6- Number of Males: In Figures () In Words ()
Animals:

Females: In Figures () In Words ()

7- Distinctive
Marks:

8- Type of Vaccination or Immunization Administered:

9- Remarks:

I, the undersigned, Dr. _____, veterinarian affiliated with _____ at the Ministry of _____, hereby certify that I have administered and supervised the vaccination of the animals referred to above _____. This Certificate has been issued to the owner accordingly.

Name

Official Seal

Signature

Date



Council Emblem

State Emblem

Country Name

Veterinary (Appendix 3)

Ministry

Department

Date: _____

No.: _____

Consignment Release Certificate

1- Category (or Type): _____

2- Quantity (or Number) _____

Weight (_____) kg

3- Name of Importer: _____

4- Name of Exporting Country: _____

5- Bill of Lading Number and Date: _____

6- Means of Transport: _____

7- Health Certificate/Undertaking No.: _____ Date: ____

The Director of _____ Customs,

Greetings,

The incoming consignment referred to above has been inspected
and found to be:

In good sanitary condition

Treated at the veterinary quarantine facility

Accordingly, we recommend that the consignment be released.

Official Seal

Signature of the Competent Officer